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Connect a Web App to Amazon Aurora



Ahmed Tetteh

The screenshot shows a web browser window with the address bar displaying 'http://100.54.219.38/Sampl'. The page title is 'Sample page'. Below the title, there is a form with two input fields labeled 'NAME' and 'ADDRESS', and an 'Add Data' button. Below the form, there is a table with three columns: 'ID', 'NAME', and 'ADDRESS'. The table contains three rows of data.

ID	NAME	ADDRESS
1	Jose	Joseluis@capricon.com
2	Tom brady	Acme Street, Warner Bros. Studio Tour Hollywood
3	Kelvin Champa	Beaver Street, The Charging Bull, Bowling Green, NY



Introducing Today's Project!

What is Amazon Aurora?

Amazon Aurora is a type of relational database that stores highly related data in rows and columns (tabular format), and why it is useful because it provides higher performance for more demanding workloads than the standard DB engines.

How I used Amazon Aurora in this project

In today's project, I used Amazon Aurora to create a MYSQL database and store all my user data for my web server. I built and connected my web application to the MYSQL database. Lastly, I verified all everything was working by installing the MYSQL CLI and running SQL queries to confirm the updates via the CLI.

One thing I didn't expect in this project was...

One thing I didn't expect in this project was how quickly data is updated in near-real time on the database, and the different tools required to communicate with the database - making it easy for us to verify everything.



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This project took me...

It took me approximately 1hr 30 mins, including setup and backgroup studies.



Creating a Web App

```
king@king-TF65577X6:~/Downloads$ ssh -i NextWorkAuroraApp.pem ec2-user@ec2-100-54-219-38.compute-1.amazonaws.com
#
##### Amazon Linux 2023
#####\
#####|
#####/
V~/^'>
https://aws.amazon.com/linux/amazon-linux-2023
Last login: Tue Mar 3 21:16:59 2026 from 49.143.191.252
[ec2-user@ip-172-31-7-153 ~]$
```

To connect to my EC2 instance, I used the key pair I initially created, changed the permissions to read-only for the owner, with no read, write or executable permissions for group or others. I also retrieved the public IPv4 address of the instance and applied it in the ssh command "ssh -i NextWorkAuroraApp.pem ec2-user@ YOUR_EC2_ADDRESS"

To help me create my web app, I first installed the Apache web server(the web server that serves content to users), PHP (the programming language to help me write beautiful web pages), then php-mysql (a PHP library that establishes a connection to my database), and finally, mariadb105 (installs MariaDB, a version of the MySQL database management system).



Connecting my Web App to Aurora

I set up my EC2 instance's connection details to my database by creating a file called "dbinfo.inc". This file stores the connection details my EC2 instance will need to establish a connection to the Aurora database.

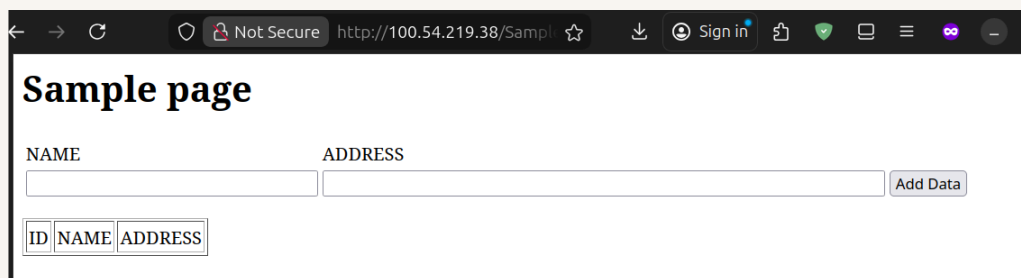
```
GNU nano 8.3 dbinfo.inc
<?php

define('DB_SERVER', 'nextwork-db-cluster-instance-1.cneciu2i488b.us-east-1.rds.amazonaws.com');
define('DB_USERNAME', 'admin');
define('DB_PASSWORD', 'n3xtw0rk');
define('DB_DATABASE', 'sample');
?>
```



My Web App Upgrade

Next, I upgraded my web app by writing a sample PHP web file that simply takes in the details of the connection to my Aurora DB, and displays any changes directly from the website.



Sample page

NAME ADDRESS

ID	NAME	ADDRESS
----	------	---------



Testing my Web App

To make sure my web app was working correctly, I logged into my database using the Mysql CLI. Then proceeded to verify my tables and the different fields within my table.

```
Welcome to the MariaDB monitor.  Commands end with ; or \g.
Your MySQL connection id is 819
Server version: 8.0.42 6252a59a

Copyright (c) 2000, 2018, Oracle, MariaDB Corporation Ab and others.

Type 'help;' or '\h' for help. Type '\c' to clear the current input statement.

MySQL [(none)]> SHOW DATABASES
-> ^C

-> EXIT
->
-> CLEAR
-> SHOW DATABASES;
ERROR 1064 (42000): You have an error in your SQL syntax; check the manual that corresponds to your MySQL server version for the right syntax to use near 'EXIT'

CLEAR
SHOW DATABASES' at line 3
MySQL [(none)]> SHOW DATABASES;
+-----+
| Database |
+-----+
| information_schema |
| mysql |
| performance_schema |
| sample |
| sys |
+-----+
5 rows in set (0.002 sec)

MySQL [(none)]> USE sample;
Reading table information for completion of table and column names
You can turn off this feature to get a quicker startup with -A

Database changed
MySQL [sample]> SHOW TABLES;
+-----+
| Tables in sample |
+-----+
| EMPLOYEES |
+-----+
1 row in set (0.002 sec)

MySQL [sample]> DESCRIBE EMPLOYEES;
+-----+
| Field | Type | Null | Key | Default | Extra |
+-----+
| ID | int unsigned | NO | PRI | NULL | auto_increment |
| NAME | varchar(45) | YES | | NULL | |
| ADDRESS | varchar(90) | YES | | NULL | |
+-----+
3 rows in set (0.002 sec)

MySQL [sample]>
```



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